Toolbox Talk: TB#09

Hazmat Communication: Corrosive

- **Skin Corrosion/Burns**
- **Eye Damage**
- **Corrosive to Metals**

Today we will discuss the specific pictogram that identifies "Corrosive" hazards (refer attached pictogram). This Pictogram is specific to certain types of chemicals such as acids and bases, inorganic salts, aldehydes, phenols, and surfactants that can have a corrosive effect on skin and membranes.

In addition, some highly-corrosive materials can cause metal containers to corrode and rupture, so take care not to store corrosive materials near metal containers. So, when you see a Pictogram depicting "Corrosive" on a product label, refer to the hazard statement(s) that appear on that label. The corrosive effects of the material you are working with may vary, from a slight irritant to highly corrosive, and the container label can provide more information about the level of hazard you are dealing with. And pay particular attention to the **Precautionary Statements appearing on the label** too, as they list recommended measures that should be taken to minimize the potential for injuries or damage resulting from improper storage, use, or handling of the corrosive product or chemical.

Examples of precautionary statements that may accompany products bearing the "Corrosive" Pictogram on the label are ***"Wear eye protection/face protection/hand protection/and/or protective clothing", "Do not breathe dusts or mists", and/or "Wash hands and exposed skin thoroughly after handling."*** You should also be aware of the location of the nearest emergency eye and/or washroom when working with corrosive materials.

Additional information about safe use and storage of a corrosive product is also available on the Safety Data Sheet (SDS) for the product. This particular pictogram should help you quickly recognize potentially hazardous associated with products that are corrosive (if possible, give specific examples of such products present at your job site).